Hocking Phishing Awareness Program (HPAP)

Phishing Awareness Training
Pause. Verify. Report.

Program Purpose

Part of the Hocking Phishing Awareness Program

Designed to reduce phishing risk across campus

Focus on behavior-based security awareness

Uses training, reminders, and reporting workflows

Why Phishing Matters

- Phishing is a primary method of credential theft
- Can lead to account compromise and data breaches
- Impacts student records, financial data, and systems
- Attackers use social engineering to exploit trust and urgency

Target Audience

- Hocking College Students
- High email, text, and online system usage
- Increased risk due to fast decision-making and convenience

Phishing Attack Vectors

- Email (most common)
- SMS/Text phishing (smishing)
- QR code phishing (quishing)
- Fake websites and login portals

Common Social Engineering Tactics

- Urgency (“Immediate action required”)
- Authority (posing as school staff)
- Fear (account suspension threats)
- Familiar branding (logos, names, formatting)

Trust Exploitation

Messages are designed to look legitimate

Attackers spoof email addresses and domains

Visual appearance is not a reliable indicator

Always validate before interacting

Scenario Example

- **Subject:** Urgent: Account Suspension Notice
- “You must verify your Hocking account immediately or access will be disabled. Click below to log in.”
- **Red Flags:**
- Urgent language
- External or mismatched link
- Request for login credentials

Behavioral Risk Insight

- Users often rely on appearance instead of verification
- Phishing is not limited to email channels
- Quick reactions increase likelihood of compromise
- Awareness must focus on decision-making behavior

Response Framework

- **Pause** – Do not act immediately
- **Verify** – Check sender, links, and context
- **Report** – Use official reporting method
- **Delete** – Remove the message after reporting

Reporting Workflow

1. Do not click links or attachments
2. Inspect the message carefully
3. Report using:
   - "Report Phishing" button OR '
   - Send to IT security email
4. Delete message after reporting

Reinforcement Strategy

Initial onboarding training

Monthly awareness reminders

Posters and campus messaging

Ongoing phishing simulations

Key Takeaways

- Phishing uses multiple channels
- Messages can appear legitimate
- Social engineering targets human behavior
- Always: Pause, Verify, Report